

Data Storytelling



Module 4: The Job Search



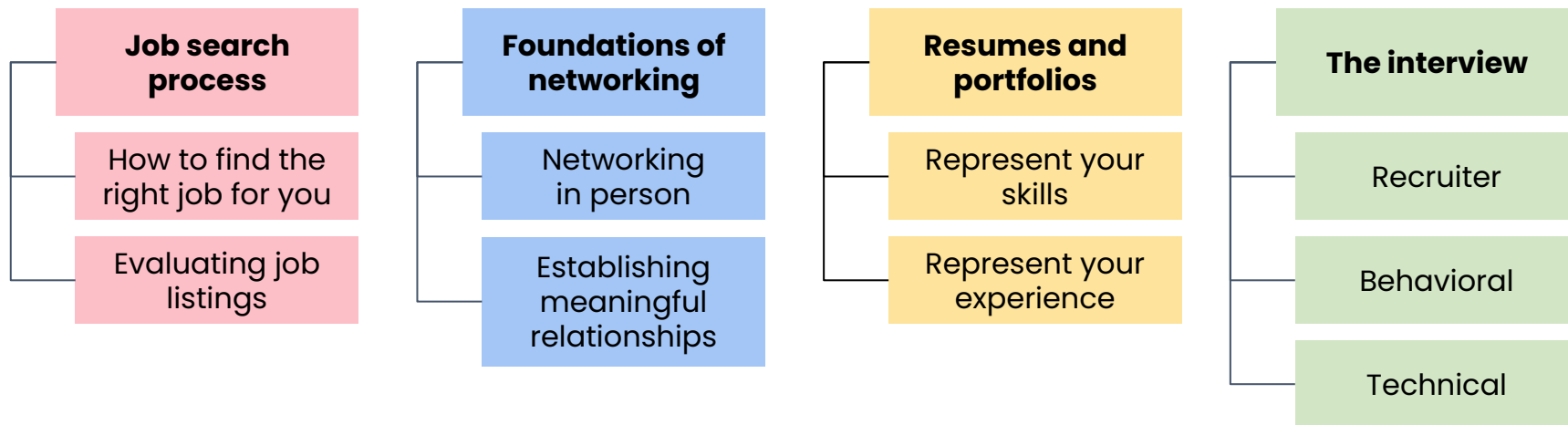


The Job Search



Module 4 introduction

Module 4 outline





The Job Search

The job search process

The job search process

- Made up of many steps you take to locate and secure a new job
- At least two parties involved:

You



- Find relevant jobs
- Make sure the job you're applying for is a good match



Hiring company



- Make sure you're qualified for the role
- Make sure goals align

Steps in the process



Varies in length depending on company



Search

- Asking friends
- Checking job boards:
 - Monster.com
 - LinkedIn
 - Indeed
- Searching individual company's careers page



Application

- Online form with:
 - Your name
 - Contact info
 - Your experience
- Upload resume and sometimes portfolio



Interview

- Face to face time
- Share your skills and passions
- Evaluate whether you would work well
- Interview types:
 - Technical
 - Behavioral
 - Case study



Offer

- Defines terms of employment:
 - Salary
 - Benefits
 - Working location
- You can:
 - Negotiate
 - Accept
 - Decline

The job search mindset

Job search requires a resilient mindset

- Emotionally challenging
- May not always get the response you're hoping for

Handle rejection gracefully

- **Doesn't** mean you're not qualified
- Might not have found the right match
- There **is** a role out there for you.

You should:

- Submit a lot of applications
- Expect you won't get a 100% yes rate
- Prioritize opportunities you are most competitive for
- Fine to target some "reach" roles

Aligning with your goals

- Think deeply about:
 - What you really want to do
 - How you want to spend your time



Example:

- If you're drawn to the movie business
- Explore opportunities in related fields:
 - Streaming
 - Studio production
 - Video editing
 - Everything in between!

- Anchoring to your goals means:
 - ✓ Staying open-minded
 - ✓ Don't limit yourself to a single job title or company
 - ✓ Be open to opportunities that could be a step towards that ultimate goal



The Job Search

Searching for jobs

Scale of the job market

US Bureau of Labor Statistics projects:



Over 20,000 job openings for data science professionals each year



Overwhelming amount for anyone looking for a new role to search

How do you sift through all those jobs to find the ones that are a good match for you?

Search strategy



LinkedIn:

- Valuable platform for networking
- Learn about company and hiring manager by viewing their profiles.



Aggregators

- Use web scraping and APIs to scan career sites, job boards, staffing agency portals, and so on.
- Create listings for each job.
- Great for viewing wide range of jobs
- May not have the most accurate and up to date information.



Company websites:

- Most accurate and up to date information
- Can be less efficient to explore

Keywords to use

- Data analysts go by many names:
 - **Business analyst**
 - **Business intelligence analyst**
 - Some companies advertise for:
 - **"Data scientist"** when role is closer to a data analyst
 - Domain-specific analyst titles:
 - **Marketing analyst**
 - **Product analyst**
 - **Financial analyst**
- ✓ Try titles alongside domain specific keywords depending on what you're looking for.
 - ✓ Start with a narrow search, then widen it over time.
 - ✓ If interested in a specific industry or niche, look for jobs there first.
 - ✓ If you're finding fewer opportunities, you can widen your funnel.

Evaluating fit

1. Scan for company fit

- ☐ Make sure start date, location, salary, and requirements of job fit with what you're looking for.

2. Identify hard requirements

- ☐ Might require:
 - Bachelor's degree
 - Research experience
- Often company knows requirements are unlikely to be fully satisfied by most candidates

3. Examine other requirements

- ☐ Years of experience
- ☐ Proficiencies
- ☐ May be more leniency if you can demonstrate related proficiencies
 - **Example:** Proficiency in MySQL
 - Make case that you have strong SQL fundamentals and would upskill into MySQL quickly.

Prioritize strong matches



Most promising roles are the ones you're truly qualified for



Nothing wrong with applying for "reach" roles



Be mindful of the opportunity cost:



Spending time for reach roles



Not spending time on more promising roles



Apply mostly for roles where:

- You're most strongly qualified
- You can provide evidence for those qualifications.



The Job Search

Networking

Building authentic relationships



A key part of networking:

- Build authentic relationship with someone at a company you want to work for



Increase likelihood that you get face time with someone



Many companies have a “referral” system

- Like an informal letter of recommendation



Emphasis: **authentic** relationships



Quality beats quantity



People can tell when you just want something from them



A LinkedIn connection to someone who doesn't know you, that's not authentic



They can't:

- Vouch for how qualified you are
- Add context about what it's like to work with you

People you know



To start building your network:

- First focus on people you know that work at places that are interesting.



A few meaningful relationships can be more impactful than LinkedIn requests



Put genuine effort into these relationships **before** you expect to need a referral!

Connect with new people

- Seek out people who are where you want to be
- Establish some connection or interest that's shared:
 - Conference both attended
 - Article you both liked
 - Shared identity
 - Same university
- Expect that not everyone is willing to offer that kind of time.
- Once you've **established** this connection:
 - ✓ Focus on **building** the connection rather than on what person can do for you.
 - ✓ Learn from people and ask questions:
 - What did you study?
 - How did you get where you are?
 - ✓ Be willing to cultivate the relationship on the other person's terms.
 - Don't lead with request for 30 min chat.
 - Any given professional might receive many of these requests.

Expand network opportunities



Other opportunities to build network:

- Local meetups
- Conferences
- Seminars



Introduce yourself and stay curious



Be authentic



Network with recruiters

- Try to stay on their radars
- Share your qualifications and types of roles you're looking for



Create your own personal brand

- Cause others to seek you out
- You'll be the one getting connection requests
- This can mean:
 - ☐ Maintaining a blog or newsletter
 - ☐ Writing on LinkedIn communities
 - ☐ Connect with people who comment on your stuff

Why networking matters



Networking is a key strategy in the job search

- Gives avenues beyond “cold applying”



Cold applying → submitting application to company without knowing anyone

- A referral from your network
- A recommendation from a recruiter
- An offer from someone who knows you well



Each is worth many cold applications!



The Job Search



Resumes & portfolios

What a resume should show



A resume is a document outlining your:

- Education
- Qualifications
- Experience
- Technical skills
- Key attributes relevant to the job



Resume should capture your personality

- Help people get a feel for who you are
- Make it easy for person reading it to imagine your potential fit

First impressions matter



Personality helps you stand out



Recruiters read 40-80 resumes per day



They spend 6-8 seconds determining initial fit



If they can't find the relevant information in that time, they'll likely move on.



If you seem like a fit, they spend ~3 more minutes examining resume in more detail.



Your goal:

- Capture enough interest so that they want to spend that extra 3 minutes with you

Content



Your resume should include:

- Education
- Work experience
- Technical skills



Highlight **impact** rather than just effort



Communicate a **diversity of skills**



Share some of your personal interests

- **Example:** Spelunking or sharks
- To help interviewer connect with you and get a sense of who you are.

Personal brand

- Resumes communicate effort and your personal brand.
- A well-styled resume says:
 - “I care about how I present myself!”

LinkedIn profile



Your LinkedIn profile acts as a de facto resume

- Hiring managers will explore your profile
- Allows you to showcase your personal brand



Make sure the photo, top-level description, experience, and education are well represented



Consider your activity:

- Example: Posts and comment
- Visible to recruiters and hiring managers

Portfolio



Maintain a portfolio of your work.

- Collection of projects that goes beyond what bulleted list in a resume can provide.
- **Purpose:** To share who you are, your interests, and what your work looks like



Isn't typically required for a data analytics role.

- Most companies have their own standardized process



Any format is fine as long as presentation and projects are of good quality



Another indication of higher effort and care that can help you stand out

How to stand out



Many people have the same degree, but no two people have the same experience.



Personality and **experience** can differentiate you from similar credentials.



As you progress, you'll have more to share about successes and challenges



The Job Search

Interviews

Recruiter interview

What it is:

- Initial screening to align on role and foundational requirements
- The recruiter:
 - Share about expected responsibilities, benefits, location, compensation
 - Ask you foundational questions about your experience
 - Isn't deeply familiar with current projects and daily experience of role.

To prepare for this interview

- Practice your personal story
 - Explain what brought you to the current opportunity
 - Why are you interested in the job?
 - Why you pivoted and how you invested in your education
- Approach as a two-way feasibility check
 - Recruiter makes sure you're eligible and note any concerns
 - You should be evaluating whether role seems like a good fit and matches your constraints

Technical interview

- Test statistics, programming, and SQL skills
- Can be synchronous or asynchronous
- Formats:
 - Take-home assignment
 - Live coding exercise
- **Examples:**
 - How would you join two tables to determine which lego themes have most sets?
 - How would you clean this dataset and handle missing values?
 - How would you visualize the relationship between time and chlorophyll concentration?



Live coding exercises:

- Collaborative
- Interviewer testing how you:
 - Break down the problem
 - Explain your approach
 - Collaborate with them



To prepare for technical interviews:

- Spend time preparing with practice problems, books, and so on
- Try coding questions on Leetcode

Behavioral interview

- Assess cultural fit for the role and soft skills
- Questions you might encounter:
 - Tell me about a time when you had to explain a complex analysis to someone without a technical background.
 - Tell me about a time when you disagreed with a coworker.
 - Tell me about an area in your work where you'd need the most support.
- Interviewer is looking to assess:
 - How you would behave as a colleague
 - How you think about different situations

- If you don't have direct experience:
 - Explain how you would approach situation.



To prepare for these interviews:

- Have some personal anecdotes ready
- Be prepared to talk about past collaborations and projects.
- Have common answers about collaboration, communicating analyses, engaging in continuous learning, and taking ownership.
- Practice questions with a large language model that can evaluate your responses and suggest areas for improvement.

Case study interview

- Test your end to end problem solving skills with a task similar to what you might encounter in the role
- Sample problem:
 - “Our company has noticed that movies have been going over budget more than usual in the past year.

Using our production data, how would you approach analyzing the increase in over-budget projects, as well as help develop strategies to improve budget adherence?”



To tackle the case study:

- **Clarify:** Restate prompt and ask one or two questions
- **Establish the domain context:** Show curiosity and capture additional information with a question
- **Walk through data analytics lifecycle**
 - Establish what data is available
 - What analyses would be appropriate.
 - Lay out a few different options
 - Describe how you would decide



The Job Search

Your next steps